the requirements-analysis process and to get a high-level view of what you're trying to achieve.

An impact map is a mind-map built during a conversation, or series of conversations, between stakeholders and members of the development team. The conversation centers around four types of questions:

- Why?
- Who?
- How?
- What?

The first question you need to ask is *why* you're building the software in the first place. Or, in other words, what are the underlying business goals you're trying to achieve? This corresponds to the business goals we discussed earlier.

Visually, each impact map starts with a single business goal at its center. For example, using our Frequent Flyer example, you might start with the first goal, "increase ticket sales revenue by 5% over the next year by encouraging travellers to fly with Flying High rather than with a rival company." This would be the first node in your impact map, as illustrated in figure 3.5.

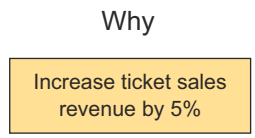


Figure 3.5 An impact map starts with the business goal you want to achieve.

In Impact Mapping, the second question to ask is *who*. Who are the stakeholders impacted by the project? Who are the users of the product? Who will benefit from the outcomes? If you're selling something, who are your customers? Who will be in a position to cause or influence the outcome you're trying to achieve? Who can prevent your project from being a success?

This is an area of requirements analysis that's often overlooked or skimmed over with a few token user roles. But the best-designed feature in the world will be of little value to the business if the users never use it or don't use it in the anticipated way. Stakeholders have their own motivations and agendas, which can be different from those of the project, and which you need to understand in the context of what you're trying to deliver. Oftentimes, to achieve a business goal, it's not enough to write software: you must also succeed in changing people's behavior.

Of course, one of the most important stakeholders in almost any project is the customer or end user. For example, the Frequent Flyer website will only be a success if it can encourage travellers to become Frequent Flyer members and book more flights with Flying High airlines. To do this, you'll need to understand and address the needs of your existing and potential customer base and deliver features that address these needs. If you're building an internal application for internal users, you'll need to understand what features will enable your users to help achieve the higher-level business goals in the most efficient way possible.

But customers and end users are not the only stakeholders that you need to consider. Executives will be interested in how the project helps them meet their business